August

AI agents for commercial banking credit work · tryaugust.com · $500,000 at seed

COMPANY	AI agents for commercial bank credit work	FOUNDED	2025, Tel Aviv
TEAM	3, two ex-8200 co-founders	BACKING	a16z speedrun SR006 (Jan to Apr 2026)
CUSTOMER	One US bank, $170B+ in assets, unnamed	REVENUE	$800K ARR in 3 months (reported)
ASK	First meeting; $500K at seed	SCREEN	Rank 10 of 54 ranked (46.8%)

I recommend a first meeting, and a $500,000 seed investment if three things check out: who the bank is and what it pays, what the reported $800K of revenue actually is, and how the product passes a bank's model risk review.

August ranked tenth of 54 in a screen I ran on early-stage Israeli fintech companies, built to find which of them can still win now that software is becoming a commodity in the vibe-coding era. The first thing it looks for: **companies that deliver the work itself, rather than a tool that helps people do it.**

ONE-LINER

August builds AI agents that do the work of a commercial bank's credit department: underwriting, loan servicing and portfolio risk. Its own line is "AI autonomous bankers", and its site calls itself "Banking's last piece of software".

TEAM

Bar Ittah, co-founder and CEO. Award-winning officer in Unit 8200. Founding team at Xperiti, acquired by Ipsos, where he launched and scaled fraud-prevention infrastructure. First employee at OnFire AI ($20M raised), where he built the AI evaluation team and scaled growth across the US and Europe.

Tom Tankilevitch, co-founder and CTO. Built the AI backbone of an intelligence unit in 8200. Tech lead at Iguazio, acquired by McKinsey, on infrastructure for deploying models. Founding team at Port ($158M raised), where he led an engineering group of about twenty building AI infrastructure.

Three people in Tel Aviv, founded in 2025, in a16z speedrun's SR006 cohort (January to April 2026). **This is a team that can build production AI and get it through a large bank's security review. It is not a team from inside a credit department.** Neither founder has held a banking, credit or regulatory role, which matters when the buyer is a chief credit officer.

PROBLEM AND MARKET

A commercial loan is a stack of manual work. An analyst collects the borrower's statements, spreads them into a standard template, analyses the ratios, writes a credit memo for the committee, and then repeats much of it every year in an annual review, alongside covenant checks and portfolio reporting. nCino, the leading commercial lending system, says a relationship review typically takes *between two days and a full week*.

The labour is the budget. The US employs about 64,000 credit analysts at a median wage of $83,510 (BLS, May 2025): roughly $5.4B a year before counting relationship managers, servicing staff, risk teams and the offshore firms, such as Acuity Knowledge Partners and Evalueserve, that banks already pay to do spreading and monitoring. The occupation is projected to shrink 4% by 2034. **Banks need more credit work done by fewer people, and they already pay outsiders to do it.**

PRODUCT AND WHY NOW

August describes the product as "domain-specific AI for commercial banking, turning underwriting, servicing, risk etc. into software", and says "usage compounds a proprietary context layer". In practice that means agents that take a step of the credit process, such as spreading, a draft memo or an annual review, and return a finished output to a banker for approval, learning each bank's policies and templates as they go.

The wedge is breadth across the loan's life, not one task. Most new entrants start at origination. August names servicing and risk as well, where the repeat work sits: every loan on the book needs reviewing every year.

Why now. Language models can now read financial statements, loan agreements and correspondence well enough to draft structured credit work. Buyers are ready for it: nCino launched its own credit analyst agent in April 2026, and EnFi raised $15M in February 2026 to sell agents to regional banks. The question in 2026 is no longer whether banks will use agents for credit work, but whose.

GO-TO-MARKET

The ideal customer is a US bank with a large commercial book and a credit team under pressure. August reached its first with a direct sale to a bank of more than $170B in assets, the hardest kind of customer to win at this stage, and reports a growing pipeline. a16z's network and its portfolio of fintech relationships are a credible second channel. No partner channel is named. **The open question is whether August sells around nCino, through it, or against it.** Each path implies a different sales motion and a different ceiling.

BUSINESS MODEL

Enterprise software sold to banks. August holds no licence, lends nothing and holds no funds; the bank is the buyer and the regulated party. Pricing is not published. If the reported revenue comes from the one bank, the first contract is worth roughly $800K a year, which is priced like headcount, not like a software seat. **The right model for this thesis is pricing per unit of work, per credit file spread or per review completed,** so that revenue scales with the labour it replaces rather than with seats.

TRACTION

Deployed at a bank with more than $170B in assets, unnamed. Stated on August's a16z speedrun profile and repeated in 36Kr's coverage of the cohort (April 2026).

$800K ARR in three months. Reported only by PingWest (April 2026), restating the company. a16z's own guidance to founders is to say whether such a figure is billed recurring revenue or annualised run-rate; I could not tell which.

Three employees. If the figures hold, that is software economics, not services economics. If they are a paid pilot annualised, the picture is very different, which is why this is the first thing to confirm.

COMPETITIVE LANDSCAPE

nCino is the competitor that matters. It is the system of record for commercial lending at many US banks, and in April 2026 it launched Analyst Digital Partner, an agent it says cuts relationship-review effort by 60% to 70%. Direct start-ups include EnFi ($15M in February 2026, $22.5M in total, positioned as an assistive tool for credit staff), Accend ($3.2M seed from Y Combinator and General Catalyst), Taktile (decisioning with agents for business underwriting) and Casca ($29M Series A for loan origination). Indirectly, August competes with offshore analyst firms for the same budget, and with large banks building their own: Truist has a commercial credit memo agent, and BNY built Eliza.

August's case for winning is that it does the work rather than assists it, that it spans servicing and risk as well as origination, and that it already runs inside a large bank. Against that, nCino owns

the workflow and the data, and a feature inside the system a bank already uses is a hard thing to sell against.

VISION

The five-year picture is the one a16z itself describes for agents above an ERP: become the system of action that sits above the loan origination system, do most of the credit work, and in time make the system of record underneath it optional. **That is what "banking's last piece of software" means, and it is the line of defence against the obvious objection that this is a feature nCino will ship.** Whether it is credible depends on how much of the bank's credit work August ends up doing, not on the model.

NEXT 12 MONTHS AND USE OF PROCEEDS

The seed should buy three proofs: a second and third bank, each signed beyond a pilot and ideally one named; a pricing unit tied to work done; and a model risk and audit package (decision trail, explanations, human sign-off) that a bank's validators will accept. It should also buy a credit insider, a hire or an advisor from inside a bank's credit function, to close the team's one obvious gap.

On the deal. a16z speedrun's standard terms are $500K for 10% on a SAFE, with a further $500K committed in the next round within 18 months, and a pro-rata right. The next round is therefore likely to be led or anchored by a16z's commitment, so an Israeli fund would join rather than lead. The speedrun money arrived in early 2026, about ten months ago, so the seed is probably near. **Three things to confirm before any money moves:** the bank and its contract terms; whether the $800K is billed, recurring and from more than one product line; and the model risk review status at the anchor bank.

RISKS

Everything rests on unverified claims. The bank is unnamed and the revenue figure appears in one article restating the company. This is the first thing to test, and it can be tested in one call.

One customer. Most or all revenue likely comes from one bank. A non-renewal would undo the traction. Against that, a bank of that size does not deploy a three-person vendor without a security and vendor review, which is itself a signal.

nCino and self-build. The incumbent already ships agents, and the largest banks build their own. The screen scored August 1 of 3 on this exposure, as it did every one of the 54 ranked companies.

No banking founder, and model risk rules. US banks must validate any model that drives credit decisions, which lengthens sales and demands explainability. A team without a credit background has to earn that trust. The fix is a hire, not a pivot.

Data does not pool. The context layer compounds inside each bank, not across banks, so it raises switching costs without creating a network effect.

OUTCOMES

$500,000 at an assumed $20M post-money seed price, 2.5% at entry, 1.25% at exit after 50% dilution. Exits valued at 4x to 8x ARR. Probabilities and bank counts are judgment; average contract value is anchored on the one reported deployment.

Scenario	Prob.	What it looks like	Banks	ARR	Exit	Return
Upside	15%	Becomes the agent layer for commercial credit at mid-size and large US banks, across underwriting, servicing and portfolio risk, and starts to displace the loan origination system.	60	$60M	$480M	**12.0x**
Base	35%	The anchor bank expands and renews; steady bank-by-bank sales into US regional and large banks, alongside nCino rather than replacing it.	20	$15M	$90M	**2.3x**
Sideways	30%	A handful of bank customers; nCino and in-house builds cap the market. Sold as a small tuck-in or acqui-hire.	5	$4.0M	$16M	**0.4x**
Loss	20%	The anchor bank does not renew, or the reported traction proves to be a paid pilot; nCino bundles the same agents.	0	$0	$0	**0.0x**
Expected	**100%**	*Probability-weighted return on invested capital*				**2.7x**

The table is priced off the one reported deployment, about $800K a year for a large bank, because no price is published. **The base case assumes 20 bank customers in six to eight years at $750K each;** the upside case assumes 60 at $1M, still a minority of US banks with large commercial books. The loss case carries 20% because the traction is unverified and the incumbent is already moving.

CONCLUSION

August is the clearest case in the screen of a company selling the work rather than the tool, into a budget that pays people today, with a large bank already running it and the world's best-known venture firm already in the cap table. Against that, the customer is unnamed, the revenue is reported rather than shown, the founders come from AI rather than credit, and nCino is moving into the same space.

The reported traction is strong enough, and cheap enough to check, to justify one meeting. **I recommend a first meeting, and a $500,000 seed investment if the three items under the deal check out.**

SOURCES

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